KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION (KPPSC)

COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR THE POSTS OF PMS OFFICERS (BPS-17)

SUBJECT: INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS (100 MARKS) — 2025

> **Time Allowed**: Three (03) Hours | **Maximum Marks**: 100 Marks
>
> **Instructions**: Attempt any **FIVE (05)** questions in all. All questions carry equal marks (20 Marks each). Answers must be analytical, objective, theoretically grounded, and supported by contemporary empirical evidence.

QUESTIONS

Q.1 The rise of China is widely interpreted as a revival of balance of power politics, signaling a global shift toward multipolarity. Analyze the political, strategic and economic factors that are shaping the new international order. (20 Marks)

Q.2 Critically evaluate the resilience of Indus Basin Treaty as a cornerstone of hydrological security in South Asia. To what extent can this agreement continue to safeguard water-sharing arrangements from broader geopolitical tension between India and Pakistan, particularly in an era of increasing water scarcity and climate change? (20 Marks)

Q.3 Analyze the expansion of BRICS and Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) through the lens of structural realism. Are these organizations best understood as nascent challengers to a US-led liberal international order, or are their internal divisions too significant to pose a coherent alternative? (20 Marks)

Q.4 Abraham Accord has been described as re-aligning Middle East geopolitics. Critically assess the impact of this new diplomatic architecture on the viability of the two-state solution for the Israel-Palestine conflict. Does it create new leverage for peace or further marginalize the Palestinian issue? (20 Marks)

Q.5 How does cross-border terrorism affect regional stability? Critically assess the Pakistan-Taliban security crisis. What are the implications of the Taliban resurgence in Afghanistan for Pakistan's external and internal security environment, particularly in Baluchistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa? (20 Marks)

Q.6 Evaluate the interplay of diplomacy and propaganda in shaping ties between states. To what extent do these tools serve as mechanisms of conflict resolution versus instruments of power projection in the modern international system? (20 Marks)